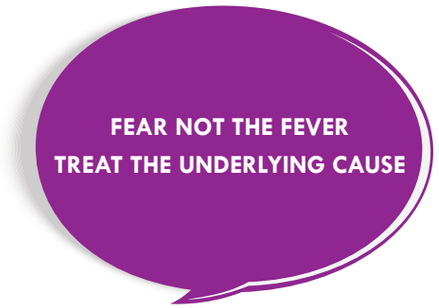


6.4. Classification of Fever

Fevers are classified according to the severity and duration of the fever.

BASED ON SEVERITY OF FEVER	BASED ON DURATION OF FEVER
Low Grade (100.5-102.1°F)	Acute or Short duration (if it lasts less than 7 days)
Moderate Grade (102.2-104.0°F)	Intermittent (if it lasts up to 14 days)
High Grade (104.1-106.0°F)	Chronic or Long duration (if it persists for over 14 days)
Hyperpyrexia (above 106.0°F)	Fevers of Undetermined Origin or FUO (exist for days or weeks)

6.4.1. Acute or Short Duration Fever

Acute fevers are of short duration with acute symptoms and the body temperature may rise to above 102°F. It may be for less than seven days. Examples are Influenza or Flu, Cold, Tonsillitis and Typhoid.

A) Influenza (The Flu)

Influenza is an acute respiratory tract infection caused by influenza virus A and B. The disease is characterized by sudden onset of chills, fever, dry cough, myalgia and generalized malaise.

The virus enters the respiratory tract and causes necrosis of superficial epithelium of trachea and bronchi. The incubation period for influenza virus is 18 to 72 hours.



Metabolic Changes During Fever

Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR) increases in severe infection with fever.
(7% increase in BMR with 1°F increase in body temperature
13% increase in BMR with 1°C increase in body temperature)

Nutrient losses are increased due to perspiration, vomiting and diarrhoea (Sodium, Potassium, Zinc, Magnesium and Phosphorus are lost)

Infection or fever accompanied by anorexia (loss of appetite) limits the food intake causing weight loss in patients

Infection can be related to state of physiological stress.
Increases catabolism in body (glycogenolysis, gluconeogenesis, protein breakdown, fat breakdown)

Absorption of nutrients also decreases if there are intestinal infections

Excessive sweat and urination is seen in severe infection or fever.
There is increased loss of body fluids and electrolytes.

Influenza is spread by droplet infection or droplet nuclei generated by coughing, sneezing or talking. Influenza affects all ages and both sexes. Often the epidemics have occurred in summer in India. Overcrowding enhances transmission of virus in the places like schools, institutions, ships, trains etc.



Activity : 3

Lights, Camera, Action!

Enact a scenario in class about different modes of transmission of diseases

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